



Natural Disasters - Public Awareness For Disaster Risk Reduction

Chapter Outline

8.1 Introduction
8.2 Public awareness for disaster risk reduction
8.3 Disasters and rules of action for disasters
8.4 Earthquake
8.5 Landslide
8.6 Cyclone
8.7 Flood
8.8 Drought
8.9 Lightning

Learning Objectives:

- *Define the terms – Disaster Risk Reduction, Resilience and Public Awareness.*
- *Understand the need for public awareness for disaster risk reduction.*
- *Explain the rules of actions for disasters.*
- *Learn and experience the various mock drills for disasters.*

8.1 Introduction

On an average, 232 million people are affected by different types of disasters every year. In recent years disaster risks have been on the rise due to factors such as population growth, unplanned urbanization, environmental degradation, conflicts and competition for scarce resources, climate change, diseases epidemics, poverty and pressure from development within high-risk zones. Hence, disaster risk reduction is the need of hour.

Recognizing the importance of Disaster Risk Reduction in 2005, 168 governments and all leading development and humanitarian actors signed the Hyogo Framework for Action (HFA), committing themselves to a ten-year multi-stakeholder and multi-sector plan to invest in disaster risk reduction as a means to building disaster-resilient societies.

Public awareness campaigns can be started modestly and tailored to meet the needs of specific populations and target groups. These approaches can

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